



The Legitimacy of

THE TGL LEAGUE

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✦ **SOCIAL ISSUE FRAMING** *and Context*

The rise of new, technology-driven sports leagues like TGL is changing how fans define legitimacy in sport.

On platforms like YouTube, audience conversations shape whether these leagues are seen as innovative or inauthentic.

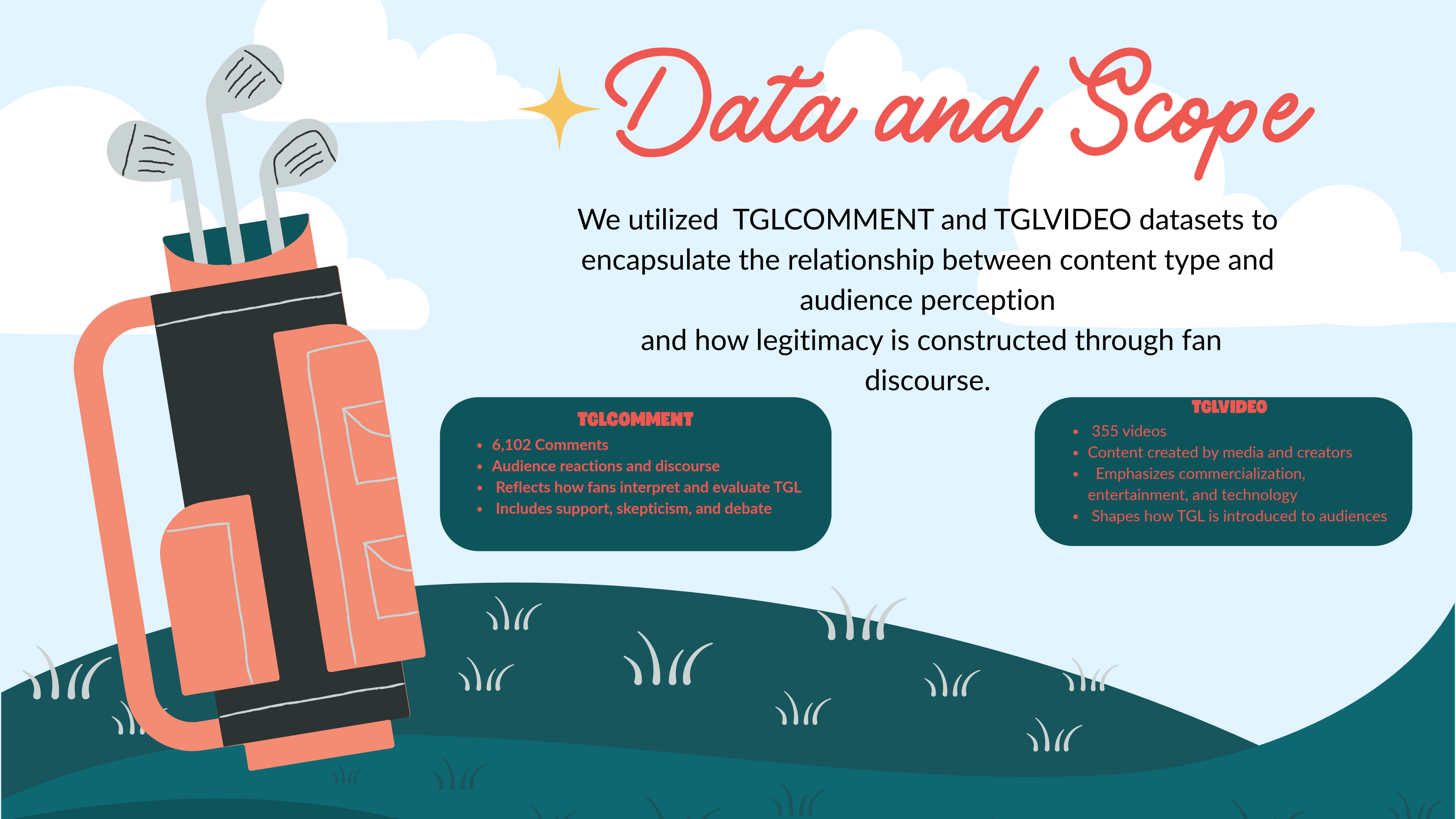


RESEARCH QUESTION

“How do YouTube content creators frame TGL's commercialization of professional golf, and in what ways does audience discourse in the comments reflect public acceptance, resistance, or ambivalence toward a technology-driven, entertainment-first sport model?”

WHY IS THIS IMPORTANT?

This matters, as the rise of the TGL shows a shift in how sports are produced, consumed, and valued. By understanding how YouTube creators and their audience consume its commercialization, we can help explain whether fans are ready for this technology-driven model or if they will remain loyal to the traditions seen in the PGA Tour or LIV Golf.



★ Data and Scope

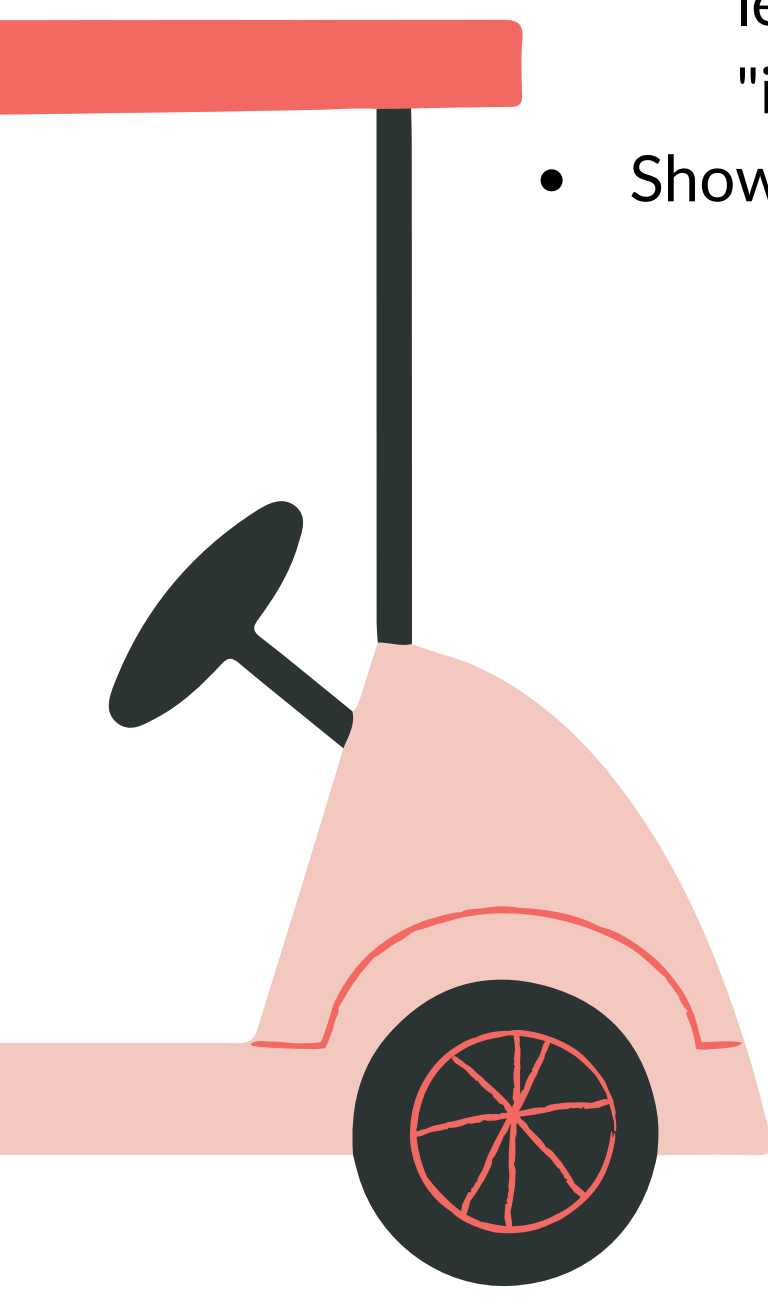
We utilized TGLCOMMENT and TGLVIDEO datasets to encapsulate the relationship between content type and audience perception and how legitimacy is constructed through fan discourse.

TGLCOMMENT

- 6,102 Comments
- Audience reactions and discourse
- Reflects how fans interpret and evaluate TGL
- Includes support, skepticism, and debate

TGLVIDEO

- 355 videos
- Content created by media and creators
- Emphasizes commercialization, entertainment, and technology
- Shapes how TGL is introduced to audiences



✦ *Analytical* **STRATEGIES**

KEYWORD/THEMATIC FREQUENCY ANALYSIS

- Identify and count key terms related to legitimacy (e.g., "real golf," "legitimacy," "innovation," "future," "entertainment")
- Shows how often certain legitimacy narratives appear in YouTube comments

TECHNOLOGY-BASED DISCOURSE ANALYSIS

- Identify comments mentioning TGL's technological features (simulator, virtual course, graphics, broadcast setup)
- Examine how those features are tied to perceptions of legitimacy

ENGAGEMENT COMPARISON

- Identify comments referencing fans' perspectives on TGL vs. traditional golf competitions
- Evaluate whether fans are actively engaging with the league in a positive or negative light

✦ KEY FINDINGS

Creator Framing

- 88.2% emphasized commercialization
- 78.3% focused on technology
- 68.5% linked the two lenses together

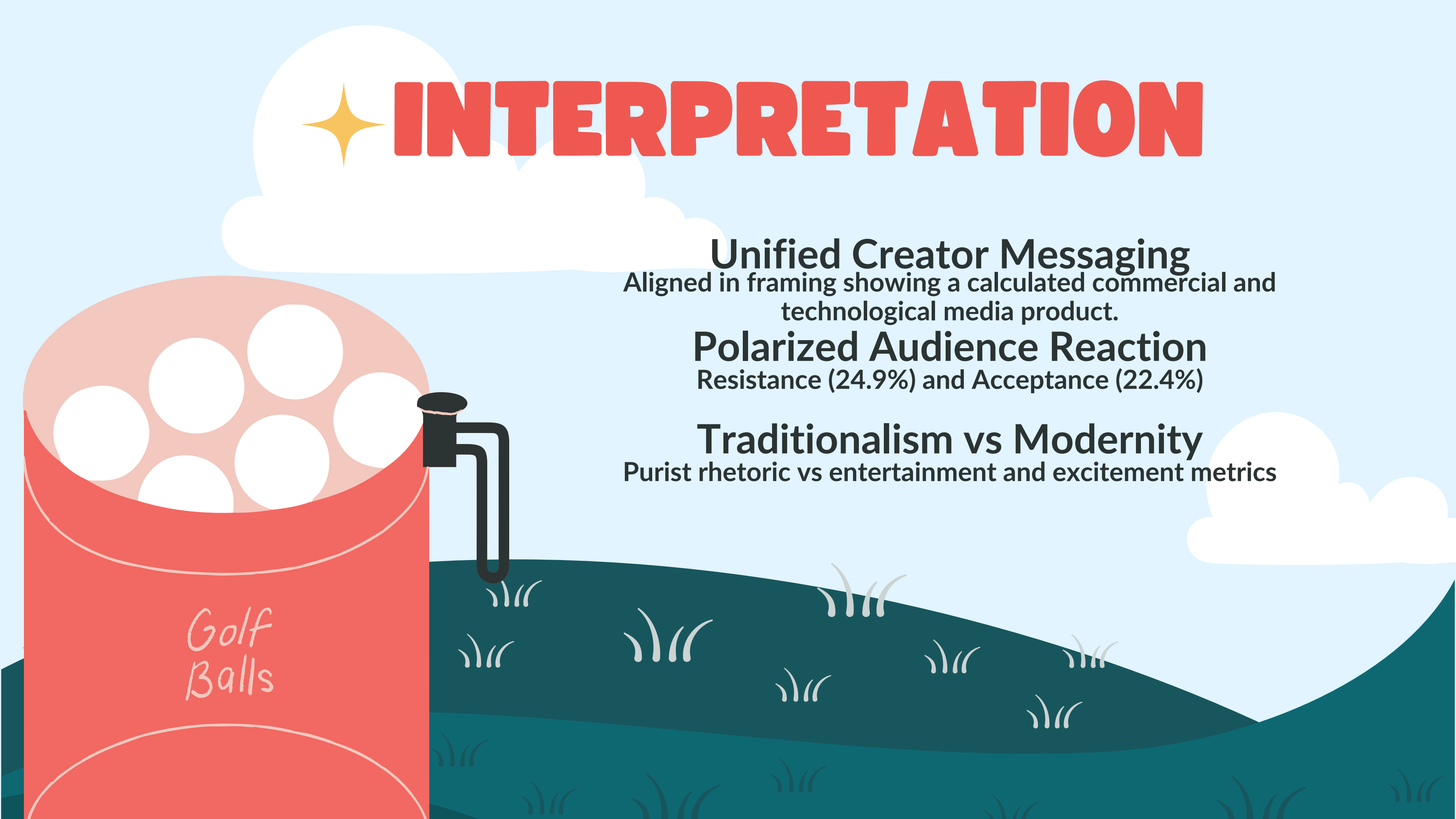
Audience Discourse

- 24.9% of comments disapproved of the TGL
- 22.4% embraced the new League model
- 9.1% were undecided

Potential Limitations

- Keyword matching can limit language nuances
- Overlap amongst keyword or ambiguous framing
- Platform Bias





★ **INTERPRETATION**

Unified Creator Messaging

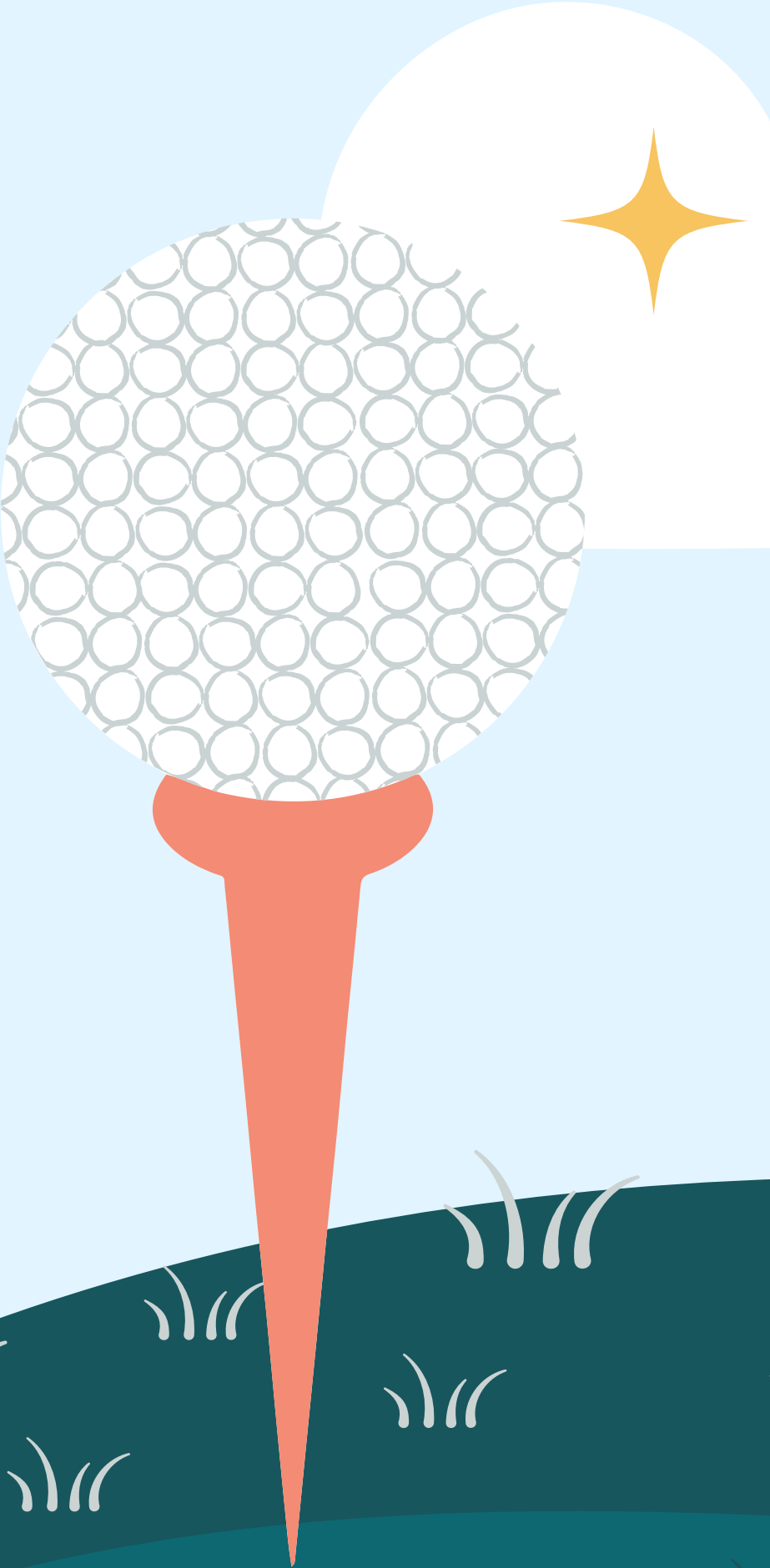
Aligned in framing showing a calculated commercial and technological media product.

Polarized Audience Reaction

Resistance (24.9%) and Acceptance (22.4%)

Traditionalism vs Modernity

Purist rhetoric vs entertainment and excitement metrics



★ IMPLICATIONS

Sport Management & Marketing

Must be prepared to manage vocal resistance and create new strategies for purists to adopt the tech-first model.

TGL's Future Strategy

Converting the 9.1% “ambivalent” crowd and proving the viability of the on-screen product, as the audience is split on the concept.

Broader Social Context

The discourse around TGL reflects a larger societal debate about the role of technology and instant-gratification entertainment in redefining legacy institutions.



THANK YOU!

Any questions?